

YUGO BREAKUP?

Successive waves of strikes by workers faced with 25% inflation, and acute nationalist tensions involving Serbia, have led to the resignation of the Federal Yugoslav Government. The system of workers self-management faces being dismantled but the concerns of workers are falling living standards and the removal of subsidies to industries in the already impoverished south. Railworkers, building, postal, utility, cleaning workers and teachers have joined the 1,400 identified strikes up to the end of 1988. The application of IMF dictated policies is causing a breakdown in the political and economic system, which may not be channelled indefinitely into intra-nationalist friction.

13 December: Hundreds of Warsaw students barricaded themselves inside the University and threw bricks and teargas at riot police on the seventh anniversary of martial law. Similar incidents took place in Gdansk on 11 December and other demos in Lublin and Lodz. A Solidarity spokesman said the Union had not organised the demos and condemned the violence. These demos have been marked by the youth of the participants and their indifference to political solidarity policy and police threats.

The majority of university students in Warsaw and Krakow are boycotting military training, Russian and socialist political economy lessons [all mandatory]. The boycott is now spreading to Gdansk. The Government has now agreed to negotiate with the students who want the classes abolished.

STUDENT POLITICAL unrest in South Africa, largely dormant since violent clashes in 1986 between black activists and police, is re-awakening in the Johannesburg township of Soweto.

During the past week, youths have burnt vehicles and stoned school buildings and on Monday local educational authorities withdrew 200 teachers from classes after some had been attacked and, in one case, stabbed. The acting head of education for the black township was reported in yesterday's press to have asked for police protection in anticipation of further violence.

LEEDS ABORTION FUND

If you were told tomorrow that all your freedom would be gone; that all your spare time would disappear; that your whole budget for your giro/low wage would have to be rearranged - practically that your life for the next 15 years would be like a prison sentence - you'd be horrified, distraught, frustrated.

That's exactly what thousands of women feel each year when they discover against their wishes that they are pregnant.

We are an organisation called "Leeds Abortion Fund" and we exist to give money to women who need to have an abortion but can't afford to pay the fees of the private clinics. Obviously,

BRAZIL:

Brazilian workers in the State sector have been engaged in fierce battles to maintain living standards. An occupation at Volta Redonda, a steel mill employing 25,000 workers 70 miles north of Rio De Janeiro, led to a confrontation on November 9th as tanks and troops killed five workers. A permanent demonstration of 8,000 workers in the town kept alive the protests and strong local and CUT solidarity. The outcry over the use of the military created a different Government response to 60,000 Petrobras Oil workers going on strike. They extended the list of 'essential services' for whom strike action is proscribed and negotiated an acceptable settlement.

In the fight to preserve the Amazonian rainforests, contradictions in the exploitation of Brazil have surfaced. The killing of Chico Mendes (on 22nd December), organiser and spokesperson of rubber tapper, rural peoples and forest Indians alliances against wealthy landowners has highlighted the terror tactics being used to extend areas for cattle grazing at the expense of the global eco-system. 1,000 resistors have been assassinated since 1980.

ABLE PROTEST

March '88.

Disabled protestors stormed the Dept. of Transportation in Washington D.C. to demand access to buses. They chained up four main doors. Staff left through an underground garage.

Overnight, locals supplied them with food and blankets. Next morning police and employees were spotted sneaking through the garage. The entrance was blocked and wheelchair demonstrators immobilised buses by sitting in front of them.

NORWAY: As public spending cuts bit country wide, 10,000 of Halden's 26,000 inhabitants struck on 3 November against the closure of the local hospital. 11 days later in Sauda 3,000 of the 5,500 population demonstrated to keep their hospital open.

BHOPAL, INDIA: Protestors attempted to storm the Union Carbide Chemical plant in December on the 4th anniversary of the disaster which killed 3,000 and crippled 26,000.

GAY STRUGGLES

The Tasmanian Gay Law Reform Group run a weekly stall to distribute information about and petition against the Criminal Code sections which outlaw sex between consenting males, with a penalty of up to 21 years in prison. In September, the Hobart City Council banned the stall and refused to negotiate with the group. The stall continued to run and on 22 October nine members were arrested - thirteen were arrested a week later. When the police made arrests onlookers protested loudly and one hundred signatures were immediately added to the petition.

Ealing Council has banned publication of a cartoon which was to have appeared in the Women's Unit Newsletter. Officials banned it under Section 28 saying it was 'promoting homosexuality'. Ealing NALGO has now condemned the Council's actions, based on assumptions about the cartoonist's intentions. NALGO says that the purpose of the cartoon was to illustrate the discrimination lesbian faces. Interestingly, Councillor Turner, Leader of Ealing Council was one of the fifteen local authority leaders who pledged they would not bow to Section 28.



the ideal situation would be for every woman wanting an abortion to get one on the NHS. However each health authority has its own policy on abortion. For example, in Leeds, only 20 out of every 100 cases does a woman successfully get treatment on the NHS. The private clinics charge at least £150 for an abortion - most unemployed women don't have this kind of money.

Help us to help these women in need by sending donations to us at: L.A.F. c/o Box 32, 52 Call Lane, Leeds LS1 6DT Cheques and postal orders made payable to "Leeds Abortion Fund"

ANTI ET ACTION

FEB 14 - 28. 2 WEEKS OF ACTION AGAINST NACRO (ET agency hoping to conscript 20,000 unemployed)

HULME TENANTS OCCUPATION

After 10 weeks in occupation, the Hulme Tenants have been granted the reinstatement of the Tenants representative on the consultation committee.